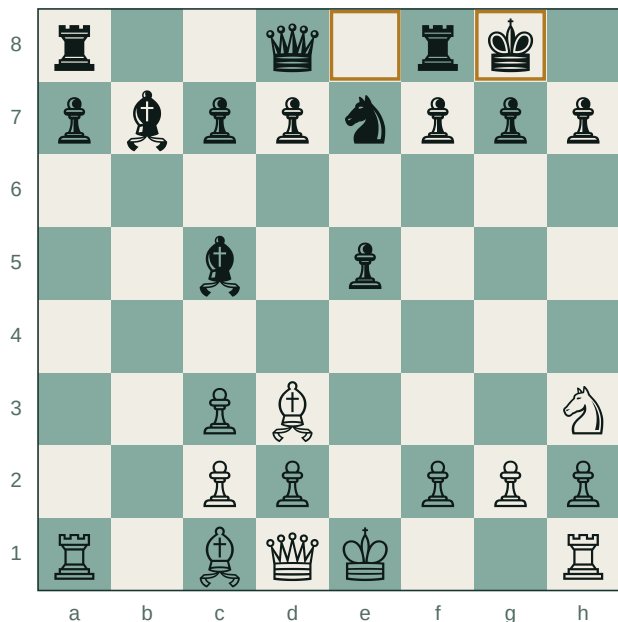


Attraction tactics: White, move 10

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 9...O-O. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

10. Bxh7+ Kxh7 11. Qh5+ Kg8 12. Ng5

10.Bxh7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on h7. Recorded reply: **10...Kxh7**.

11.Qh5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **11...Kg8**.

12.Ng5 The knight moves from h3 to g5.

At the end, nominal material is White 31 / Black 34 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by -2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -2: the balance goes from -1 to -3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b7 and bishop on c5. Check for tactical protection.